

iPhone 15 Plus

A massive leap forward

The iPhone 15 Plus, which I'm reviewing, even benefits from having a larger capacity battery. And you get all of this at the same price as the iPhone 14 Plus when it launched last year. The specifications and features look drool-worthy on paper – a Pro in almost every way but its name. However, does the iPhone 15 Plus warrant you spending a hefty ₹90K and how does it fare against competition? Let's delve further into that.

BUILD AND DESIGN

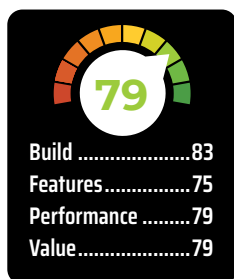
The iPhone 15 Plus looks very charming – the subtle pastel hues look classy. The aerospace-grade aluminium frame is ever-so-slightly contoured around the edges, making this phone more comfortable to hold but I still won't say that it's the most comfortable form factor due to its size and weight.

The weight, however, is pretty well distributed. I got the Pink-coloured unit and I found this pastel pink hue to be pretty palatable. Additionally, Apple has introduced a soft-matte finish on the vanilla 15s this year, replacing the glossy finishes and I'm a big fan of this change because it essentially bids goodbye to fingerprint marks and smudges.

One of the biggest changes is that the Lightning port (RIP) has been replaced by Type-C. The speeds, unlike the Pro models, top out at USB 2 though with a peak data transfer speed of 480 Mbps, which is about the same as Lightning. I'm hoping to see Apple offer USB 3 speeds across the board next year *fingers crossed*.

The iPhone 15 Plus also benefits from Dynamic Island this year which gives the phone a unique look and is pretty useful as well for multitasking and being aware of what's happening in your phone's apps in the background. Being a large phone, the iPhone 15 Plus is still quite unwieldy,

₹89,900



however, the design language and build scream premium – which is what you paid for.

DISPLAY

I'm a big fan of iPhone displays – the symmetrical bezels are always a huge win in my book and this time around, they're slimmer

as well. The 6.7-inch Super Retina XDR OLED panel looks fantastic with accurate colours, excellent viewing angles and impressive brightness levels. HDR content looks great and there's support for Dolby Vision as well. The brightness is one of the key upgrades this year, with the peak brightness going all the way up to 2000 nits, according to Apple.

In my tests, I got a reading of 1,785 nits of peak brightness in Auto mode under direct sunlight – very impressive stuff. Unfortunately, apart from the brightness levels, the displays have remained the same as compared to last year's models. There's no ProMotion on the vanilla models. Coming from 120 Hz screens, you can really tell the difference if you have

a keen eye. You can especially tell the difference if you keep the iPhone 15 Pro (or even last year's 14 Pro) and iPhone 15 Plus side by side. Another feature missing is the Always On display. The AOD on the Pro models looks fantastic – albeit a bit too bright to be efficient in my opinion – so it's unfortunate that the vanilla models miss out on this.

PERFORMANCE

When Apple announced that the vanilla iPhone 15 models would feature last year's A16 Bionic chipsets with *improved* performance, I won't lie, I felt my eyes roll a bit. However, to my surprise, the performance improvements compared to last year's iPhone 14 Pro Max shocked me.

In AnTuTu, the iPhone 15 Plus astounded me with a score of more than 1.4 million – which is a HUGE uptick compared to the 9,68,642 score of last year's iPhone 14 Pro Max. It even beat out competitors such as the Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra, Xiaomi 13 Pro, and Vivo X90 Pro. However, the newest foldable from Samsung held a small lead in AnTuTu. In GeekBench though, there was no competition, with the iPhone 15 Plus bringing in a significantly higher score than all other competitors.

The iPhone 15 is noticeably behind most modern-day Android flagship phones. It scored 3,006 points in 3D Mark Wild Life Extreme, which is decent enough. However, in GFXBench, the iPhone 15 Plus' benchmark scores did not hold a candle to the Galaxy S23 Ultra, Vivo X90 Pro, and Xiaomi 13 Pro.

Synthetic Benchmarks don't always tell the full story though. I never felt a lack of performance when I was gaming or doing any intensive tasks. Playing games such as BGMI and Call of Duty: Mobile is a smooth affair with the phone running at maximum settings without instances of too much lag. I did notice slight heating after 20-ish minutes of running COD: Mobile but it isn't unmanageable. I even edited a 4K video and the phone exported the edited file in a jiffy.

Apple has nailed the fluidity of the phones for a while now, and there's no change in that regard, which is a good